

PAYBACK TIME FOR FREEDOM FIGHTERS



Mr Bhopinder Singh Hooda honours freedom fighters at a function of All India Freedom Fighters Successors Organisation in Delhi

The Indian freedom struggle was unique in its character. It brought the people of India together under the banner of one nation. Right from the First War of Independence in 1857, the country's leadership resolved to win freedom by fighting one of the most peaceful liberation movements in world history. The Independence was the result of a 90-year intense struggle based on India's value system nourished by the blood of millions of martyrs.

Haryanvis played a leading role in

We are independent today because of the sacrifices of our valiant freedom fighters. They struggled hard to throw the British out of India. Many laid down their lives. There were many more who spent years in jail under horrible conditions. They are our real heroes, we salute them. We cannot repay their debt. But we do acknowledge their selfless service by paying them a pension of Rs 6,000 per month. We are also taking care of their grand children by providing them scholarships.

-Buphinder Singh Hooda
Chief Minister, Haryana

this. Used to bear the brunt of invaders right from the medieval times, the history is replete with the saga of their bravery and valour. Hundreds of Haryanvis were sent to the Andaman and Nicobar Islands for their 'anti-state crimes'. The women of Haryana were not far behind when it came to fighting the colonial rulers. The women martyrs of 1857 from Haryana were an inspiration for the later movements. Kasturba Bai, Manni Devi, Gayatri Devi, Chitra Devi, Laxmi Bai Arya and Suhag Rani were some of